

Section 1 set texts: Shakespeare	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners study one Shakespeare play. The set texts for examination until 2026 are: • Coriolanus • Hamlet • Measure for Measure • Richard III • The Tempest • Twelfth Night The set texts for first teaching from 2025 and examination from 2027 are: • Hamlet • King Lear • Othello • Richard III • The Taming of the Shrew • The Tempest	Learners are required to analyse the text in close detail, exploring Shakespeare's use of language and dramatic effects. Learners are required to consider issues raised in a specific extract in relation to their understanding of the play as a whole. Learners are required to explore ways in which the chosen play is/has been interpreted by different audiences, including over time.	• analyse ways in which Shakespeare shapes meanings in the chosen play including the function and effects of structure, form and language • articulate informed, personal and creative responses to the chosen Shakespeare play, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression • explore the play informed by different interpretations • consider different interpretations across time.

Where a passage is printed on the question paper it will be taken from the *The Complete Works of William Shakespeare: The Alexander Text* (Collins Classics). Centres are free to use any edition of their chosen Shakespeare text but should avoid using heavily edited editions.